

TOPIC EXPLORER

Plants Around Us | Science (EVS) | Class III

SOF Olympiad Prep

Did you know that the Rafflesia — the world's largest flower — has NO leaves, stems, or roots at all? It lives entirely hidden inside another plant and only pops out to bloom! Meanwhile, the sunflower slowly turns its head all day to follow the sun across the sky. Plants are far more clever than they look!

KEY CONCEPTS

- Plants come in 5 types — Trees (big, tall, trunk), Shrubs (bushy, woody stems), Herbs (soft green stems), Climbers (need support to grow up), and Creepers (grow along the ground). Every plant you see belongs to one of these groups!
- Leaves are called the "kitchen of the plant" because they make food for the whole plant. They use sunlight, water and carbon dioxide in a process called Photosynthesis.
- The green colour in leaves comes from a pigment called Chlorophyll — it is what captures sunlight and powers food-making.
- A seed needs air, water and warmth to sprout into a new plant. This process is called Germination. The tiny new plant that appears is called a Seedling.
- Plants give us so much — food, medicine, wood, paper, cotton and even the oxygen we breathe. Saving paper means saving trees!

GOING FURTHER

One large tree can produce enough oxygen for two people to breathe for an entire year — and it absorbs harmful carbon dioxide at the same time!

Some plants actually eat insects! The Venus Flytrap snaps shut like a trap when a bug lands on it. These are called carnivorous (meat-eating) plants.

SOF Tip: The trickiest questions mix up climbers and creepers. Remember — climbers go UP (money plant, grapevine), creepers go ALONG the ground (pumpkin, watermelon).

QUICK VISUAL — Types of Plants at a Glance

Plant Type	Stem	Example
Tree	Thick, woody (Trunk)	Neem, Mango, Peepal
Shrub	Woody, bushy	Rose, Tulsi, Hibiscus
Herb	Soft and green	Mint, Spinach, Coriander
Climber	Weak — needs support	Money Plant, Grapevine
Creeper	Weak — grows on ground	Pumpkin, Watermelon

TRY THIS!

Look around the room you are in right now. Can you spot 3 things made from plants? Hint: the paper of your book (tree), mint leaves in the kitchen (herb), cotton in your shirt (shrub). How many can you find in 30 seconds? Go!